A CRM APPLICATION FOR THE CHAI SHOP & CO

1. BRAINSTORMING & IDEATION PHASE

1.1 Introduction

Customer relationships are particularly important for a food and beverage business because customers may visit repeatedly and their preferences can influence future purchases. A CRM application provides a centralized way to organize customer information and interactions rather than depending on scattered notebooks, spreadsheets, or individual employee memory. CRM systems can maintain customer information, track interactions, manage leads and opportunities, and support customer service activities.

Chai Shop & Co. is considered as a small-to-medium-sized chai and refreshments business for this project. The shop may offer different varieties of tea, coffee, snacks, desserts, and other refreshments. Customers may include regular visitors, students, office employees, families, tourists, and online customers.

The major problem identified is the absence of a dedicated customer relationship system. Basic transaction records may tell the business what was sold, but they do not necessarily provide a complete picture of the customer relationship.

For example, a customer may regularly purchase masala chai and samosas. Another customer may prefer ginger tea without sugar. A CRM system can store such preferences when they are voluntarily provided or recorded from customer interactions.

1.2 Existing Problems

The brainstorming process identified several possible problems:

- Customer information may be stored manually.
- Staff may not know customer preferences.
- Customer feedback may not be systematically recorded.
- Loyalty programs may be difficult to manage manually.
- Follow-ups may be forgotten.
- Promotional offers may not be personalized.
- Customer complaints may not be tracked until resolution.
- Management may have difficulty identifying customer trends.
- Important customer information may be scattered across different sources.

A CRM can address some of these problems by creating a single customer record and making customer interaction information available to authorized staff. Centralized customer information is a common CRM function.

1.3 Brainstorming Process

During brainstorming, the project team discusses possible features that could improve customer management at Chai Shop & Co.

The initial ideas include:

1. Customer registration
2. Customer login
3. Customer profile
4. Order history
5. Customer preferences
6. Loyalty points
7. Reward management
8. Customer feedback
9. Complaint management
10. Promotional offers
11. Birthday/anniversary offers
12. Staff dashboard
13. Customer search
14. Customer segmentation
15. Sales reports
16. Customer activity reports
17. Feedback reports
18. Notification system
19. Data backup
20. Administrator management

The team then evaluates each idea according to usefulness, complexity, cost, and relevance to the business.

1.4 Proposed CRM Concept

The proposed system will function as a centralized CRM application.

The basic customer journey can be represented as:

Customer Registration → Customer Profile → Order → Interaction History → Loyalty Points → Feedback → Personalized Offer → Repeat Visit

The system should make it possible for authorized employees to view relevant customer information while maintaining appropriate access restrictions.

The CRM should not unnecessarily collect personal information. Only information required for the business purpose should be collected, and access should be provided according to employee responsibilities.

1.5 Project Objectives

The main objectives are:

- To develop a centralized customer management system.
- To store customer details systematically.
- To record customer interactions.
- To maintain customer purchase history.
- To implement a loyalty-point mechanism.
- To manage customer feedback and complaints.
- To support promotional campaigns.
- To provide useful reports for management.
- To reduce repetitive manual customer-management tasks.
- To improve the consistency of customer service.
- To provide an easy-to-use interface for employees.
- To maintain secure access to customer information.

CRM systems can help businesses centralize customer information and coordinate sales, service, and marketing activities.

1.6 Project Scope

The project covers:

Customer Module

- Registration
- Profile management
- Customer search
- Preferences
- Interaction history

Order Module

- Order records
- Product information
- Purchase history

Loyalty Module

- Points
- Rewards
- Redemption history

Feedback Module

- Ratings
- Comments
- Complaints
- Resolution status

Promotion Module

- Offers
- Campaigns
- Customer communication

Admin Module

- User management
- Product management
- Reports

1.7 Feasibility

- **Technical feasibility:**
  The application can be developed using commonly available web technologies and database systems.

- **Economic feasibility:**
  A small CRM can be designed with limited infrastructure requirements. Cloud or local deployment can be considered according to the shop's needs.

- **Operational feasibility:**
  The system is intended to be simple enough for employees with basic computer knowledge.

- **Schedule feasibility:**
  The project can be divided into eight phases and completed incrementally.

- **Expected Outcome**

The expected outcome is a working CRM application that allows Chai Shop & Co. to manage customer relationships digitally.

The application should allow authorized employees to quickly retrieve customer information, understand previous interactions, record feedback, manage loyalty activities, and generate reports.

The ideation phase therefore establishes the foundation for the remaining project phases.